

Integrating the Military Instrument to enhance social resilience

Assess the utility and limitations of the military as an instrument of national power in addressing non-traditional national security threats in concert with other instruments available to states.

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Presentation Structure

Executive Summary

Sinéad

- The problem
- Theoretical context
- Context case study

Adam

- Organisational adaptation
- Resilience synergy

Romin

- Irish case studies
- US case studies

Conclusion

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Societal resilience is the WHY.

Without Civil-Military trust, integration is shallow and resilience is weak.

Requires a whole-of-society approach

A renewed focus on home defence

Resilience is vital to modern deterrence (Thornton 2025)

Define the Problem



(Vincent, 2025)

Instruments of
National Power



(DF Leadership Doctrine, 2023)

Military Instrument



(Khattak, 2025)

Non traditional
national security
threats



(Rohan et al, 2013)

Societal
Resilience

Theoretical Context



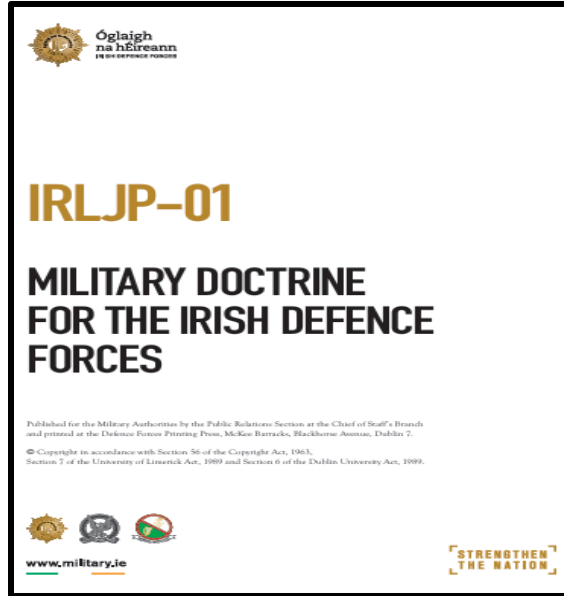
Theory – Question - Strategy

TRINITY LINK	QUESTION LINK	STRATEGY LINK
Government	National Power	Ways
- For the strategic approach, the ways refers to how the Government decides to address national security threats - All political institutions, including Governments, are manifestations and materializations of power (Nation 2003) - Governments are the guardians of national power and they survive or decline at the will of the people		
Army	Military Instrument	Means (One element)
- For the strategic approach, the means, refers to the resources needed to accomplish the ends - Military instrument deployed, as one means, at the discretion of Government in concert with other instruments		
People	Societal Resilience	Ends
- For the strategic approach, the ends, refers to stability and enhancing societal resilience - The people can sometimes be overlooked but they are central to the trinity and the power of the people should not be underestimated - Democracy is driven by the people - Government elected & remains in power by the will of the people		

All three forces are interrelated and if one force collapses this may lead to failure or in this case a lack of societal resilience

The Context Case Study - Ireland

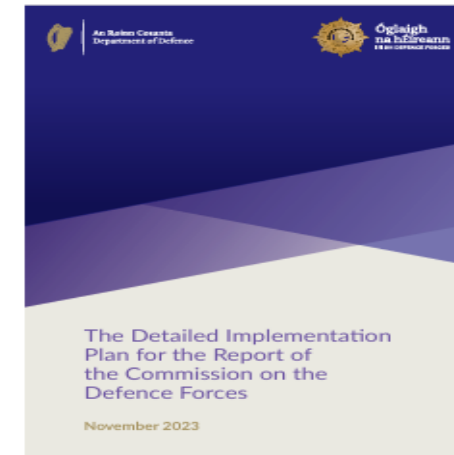
Identifying
non
traditional
security
threats



Defence Policy Review 2024



Strategic Framework



Detailed Implementation Plan for the Report of the Commission on the Defence Forces

The Context Case Study

Non traditional
security threats

SUCCESSFUL
utility of the
military
instrument

Ireland's
critical
infrastructure

Political Factors (WAYS)

- National risk assessment
- Defence strategy

Ethical Factors

- Perceived Societal value

Logistical Factors (MEANS)

- Geography
- Maritime capabilities

Strategic Factors (ENDS)

- Societal resilience

The Context Case Study

Non traditional
security threats

LIMITED
utility of the
military
instrument

Pandemic &
health security

Political factors
(WAYS)

- Government response
- NPHET

Ethical factors

- Deaths
- Restrictions

Logistical factors
(MEANS)

- COVID tests
- Contacting tracing
- Testing centres

Strategic factors
(MEANS)

- Societal resilience

Organisational Adaptation and Interagency Synergy

Without civil-military trust, integration is shallow and resilience is weak



Civil Military Trust

- Ireland's model of "subjective control" (**Huntington, 1957**) prioritised supervision over cooperation
- Civilian oversight, rooted in fear not confidence, discourages professional autonomy (**Cottey, 2002; Brooks, 2024; Feaver, 1999; Feaver, 2003; Feaver, 2003A**)
- Trust-based governance would convert control from constraint to enabler
- Democratic maturity requires friction with integrity, not micromanagement (**Janowitz, 1960; Cohen, 2002; Burk, 2002; Cook, 2019**)
- Garda paradox



(A.G.S., n.d.)



(Óglaigh na hÉireann, 2010)



(Irish Defence Forces, 2022)



(Quann 2022)

Ethics and Oversight

- Authority ≠ Accountability (**Burk, 2002; Cook, 1999**)
- Ethics by design, not by directive (**Cohen 1996, Miller 1997**)
- Ethical design must precede ethical regulation
- Over-securitisation erodes legitimacy faster than external threats
- Each resilience role trades readiness, neutrality, or perception (**Feaver, 1999; Moskos, 2001; Cottey, 2005**)
- Hence the need for proportion and consent (**Cottey, 2002, Cohen, 202; Burk, 2002**)



Concordance and Culture

- **Schiff's (1995)** concordance theory shows resilience depends on shared norms between the military, political elites and society
- Ireland scores well on representation, recruitment, and culture, but poorly on political inclusion (**Empathy Research, 2024**)
- Bureaucratic caution and elite scepticism sustain separation and limit agility (**Dáil Éireann, 2024**)
- Strengthening dialogue would reduce supervision and enable adaptive governance (**Janowitz, 1960; Schiff, 1995; Moskos, 2001; Brooks, 2024**)



Trust → Adaptation → Resilience

- Ethical trust underpins effective adaptation
- Mission command embodies trust in action
- It links autonomy to accountability
- True resilience emerges when Defence compliments, the diplomatic-informational-economic instruments of power
- The Defence Forces have guarded the State for a century, yet the State still seems to guard itself from them



2021 HSE Ransomware Attack – Ireland

- Health Service Executive (HSE) suffered a massive ransomware attack, crippling healthcare systems nationwide.
- The Defence Forces' CIS Corps provided:
 - Technical support to HSE and National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC)
 - Network isolation and forensic analysis assistance
 - Secure communications support during recovery

Utility

1. Rapid deployment of Technical expertise
2. Interagency cooperation
3. Capability development

Limitations

1. Limited manpower and specialization
2. Legal uncertainty
3. Strategic gap

Lessons Learned:

Military cyber capabilities are essential for national resilience, but must be integrated into a whole-of-government framework with clear legal authority



2022 Humanitarian Aid and Refugee Reception – Ireland

- Ireland received over 100,000 refugees following Russia's invasion of Ukraine
- The Defence Forces supported by:
 - Converting military facilities into emergency shelters
 - Built and maintained refugee accommodation sites
 - Assisted with logistics, transport, and supply distribution

Utility

1. Speed and organization
2. Whole-of-government coordination

Limitations

1. Sustainability
2. Manpower trade-off

Lessons Learned:

The Defence Forces are vital as a short-term stabiliser humanitarian emergencies, however long-term integration and housing must shift to civilian management



2005 Hurricane Katrina – U.S.A.

- Large domestic disaster response with confusion between federal, state, and local authorities
- Unclear command relationship delayed military and civilian response
- Friction between military and civilian agencies
- Public perception of incompetence

Utility

1. Massive manpower and assets
2. Air and sea mobility
3. Restoration and order

Limitations

1. Delayed response
2. Legal restrictions
3. Perception issue

Lessons Learned:

Need pre-existing civil-military plans, clearer authorities, and implement and practice whole-of government responses.



California Wildfires – U.S.A.

- Each wildfire season, the California National Guard and Air National Guard assist civil authorities with firefighting, evacuation, and aerial reconnaissance
- The military forces supported by:
 - Specialized units operate C-130 aircraft equipped with Modular Airborne Firefighting Systems
 - Drones and satellite systems aid damage assessment and predictive mapping

Utility

1. High-tech assets
2. Flexible manpower
3. Public approval

Limitations

1. Training Diversion
2. Funding constraints
3. Strategic overreliance

Lessons Learned:

The wildfires demonstrate that while the military provides critical surge capacity, a sustainable civilian disaster management system is vital for long-term resilience



Comparative Insights

Dimension	Common Strengths	Common Limitations
<u>Political</u>	Visible state power, public reassurance	Legitimacy & oversight
<u>Logistical</u>	Rapid response, engineering, air/sea lift	Sustainment costs, interoperability
<u>Ethical</u>	Save lives, builds trust	Risk of coercion, militarization of aid
<u>Strategic</u>	Enhances resilience, soft power	Mission creep, reduced readiness



CONCLUSION

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A renewed focus on home defence

Resilience is vital to modern deterrence (Thornton 2025)

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THANK YOU!